1.1.63

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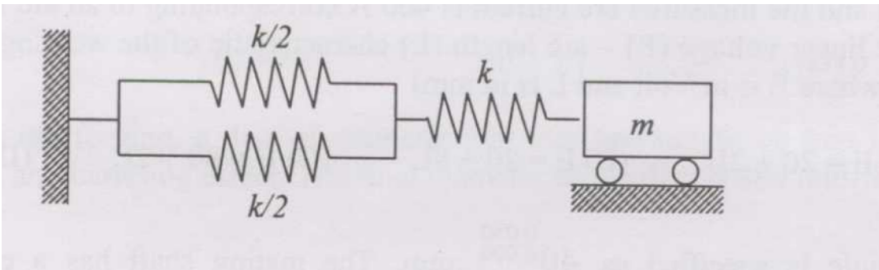
Question

The natural frequency of the system shown below is (ME 2007)



a) $\sqrt{\frac{k}{2m}}$ b) $\sqrt{\frac{k}{m}}$ c) $\sqrt{\frac{2k}{m}}$ d) $\sqrt{\frac{3k}{m}}$

Solution :

Two springs of stiffness $k/2$ are connected in parallel, and this combination is in series with a spring of stiffness k, attached to a mass m.

Parallel Combination :

Springs are in parallel when they have the same displacement. The equivalent stiffness is:

$$k_{\text{parallel}} = k_1 + k_2 \tag{1}$$

Here,

$$k_{\text{parallel}} = \frac{k}{2} + \frac{k}{2} = k \tag{2}$$

Series Combination : Springs are in series when they experience the same force. The equivalent stiffness is:

$$\frac{1}{k_{\text{eq}}} = \frac{1}{k_1} + \frac{1}{k_2} \tag{3}$$

Thus,

$$\frac{1}{k_{\text{eq}}} = \frac{1}{k} + \frac{1}{k} = \frac{2}{k} \tag{4}$$

$$k_{\text{eq}} = \frac{k}{2} \tag{5}$$

Natural Frequency :
The natural frequency is given by:

$$\omega_n = \sqrt{\frac{k_{\text{eq}}}{m}} \tag{6}$$

Substituting,

$$\implies \omega_n = \sqrt{\frac{k}{2m}} \tag{7}$$